

Community

Two of our readers opine about the future on technology in India and of six web sites that everyone should know.



16-camera Rig

GoPro makes its 360 degree camera available
<http://dgit.in/Odyssey16>

Giving the Evil AI

When some of the smartest people on earth such as Stephen Hawking and Elon Musk voice their concerns about sophisticated AI being something you'd want to watch out for, then you know not to take the threat of AI lightly. We pick some of the most evil ones from movies and games.



Battlestar Galactica

Humans get blitzed out of existence by an Alien robotic race known as the Cylons. Through the ages they've gone from looking like big metal clunk-a-saurus to being exactly like humans with flesh and blood coating. Their level of sentience is such that towards the end *SPOILER* they start fighting each other and kill off the evil ones amongst them. Karma's a Six.

Star Trek

The Borg are an ancient race that came to existence thanks to the race for perfection when humanoid species started sticking or should we say 'assimilating' technology into their bodies. After a while they met other species with better bodies and guess what...assimilated them and became even more powerful. Needless to say, the Borg collective is one race you'd best avoid.



Ultron

Perhaps you aren't nerdy enough to know about Cylons or the Borg but you'll know this one. Ultron was made to be a protective shield for humanity, the one last thing Dr. Henry Pym or Tony Stark and Bruce Banner would have to do before taking off to Hawaii and retiring for good. Ultron kicked their butt and they were superheroes. We don't stand a chance.



System Shock

Even if a system is programmed to perfectly keep the human interests in mind you can always count on the said humans to screw-up the un-screw-up-able. This is what happens in the game System Shock where the AI's restraints are removed to allow a corrupt guy to 'delete' certain files. The AI, SHODAN then goes bonkers and starts slaughtering everyone in the facility.

Mass Effect

Sometimes you create an AI so powerful and so megalomaniacal that when it turns evil, it not only screws you over but even other species in the galaxy. Everything about the Reapers from the Mass Effect series, from their appearance to the loud boom that preceded their arrival is enough to make the collective population of the entire planet crap their pants.



2001: A Space Odyssey

This one didn't impact the entire race but it's one of the most iconic instances of when an AI went rogue. HAL 9000 was the onboard computer on a long distance space-faring mission. When faced with the threat of being shut down it decided to take matters into its own hands and kill the astronauts on board. The cheeky bugger even tried to make it look like an accident.